special class-privileges and vested interests, but that did not help the Congress one jot or title. With a popularity only second to that of the Mahatma, with unbounded prestige among his countrymen, with a clear brain possessing the finest ideas, with an up-to-date knowledge of modern world movements—that he should be found wanting in the essential quality of leadership, namely the capacity to make decisions and face unpopularity if need be,[1] was a great disappointment. But there was no help for it. What had been expected of him had to be accomplished by lesser men.

After Pandit Nehru, Mr. K. F. Nariman, the Bombay leader, was released and without delay he began to give public expression to his views[2] on the decisions of the Poona Conference in July 1933. Referring to the Mahatma's decision to start civil disobedience in August 1933, because the Viceroy did not grant him an unconditional interview, he said, '"Interview or Death" is the national slogan for the present....The renewed fight in August last is not for Swaraj, nor even for political constitutional advance, but for the assertion of a supposed "national right" of an unconditional interview. If that right was conceded, even the modified individual fight would be called off and peace between Government and the people restored, though the Congress political goal is not satisfied.' Speaking of the Mahatma's condemnation of secrecy, he remarked : 'By what rule of modern warfare or sport are we bound to disclose our plans and schemes beforehand to the enemy ? But I forget, it is a religious fight and not political; so neither the rules of sport nor the canons of modern warfare apply ! Secrecy of one's plans and future actions is the very essence of all modern national movements and struggles.' On the decision to call off 'mass', but retain 'individual' civil disobedience, he stated: 'Does it need an Indian National Congress to tell an individual to break laws on his own responsibility and take the consequences? ....That eternal liberty to act as he likes and take the consequences is given to man since the days of Adam.' Then he dealt with the Mahatma's assertion that 'continuance by even one person (of civil disobedience) ensures revival into such an irrepres-

[1] This defect in Pandit J. L. Nehru was manifest on other occasions as well, when the Congress passing through a crisis—e.g., in the crisis of 1923-24 and subsequently in the crisis of 1928-29.

[2] For a full statement of his views one should refer to his book, *Whither Congress?* Bombay Book Depot, Girgaon, Bombay, November 1933. Mr. Nariman has been a member of the Congress Working Committee since January 1930.